

Week 2: Professional “narrative”

- From an elevator pitch to a self-introduction and a CV
- Life is short, time is up, people do not read emails or CV.

BTW... have you Googled your own name?

BTW... have you created a web presence?

Your own career in Bioengineering

1. **What do you gravitate toward?**
2. **Autonomy or stability?**
3. **Contributor or manager?**
4. **One in, one out.**

last week



Something you say... aloud

in under a minute!

today

4-part pitch

Problem

The gap that made the work worth doing, told in a way a non-specialist could follow it.

Approach

What you did, in one sentence!
A little jargon signals competence, but not too much!

Finding

The result, as a claim
"we showed X" (not "we looked at whether X...")

Relevance

Why the listener should care.
It matters most.

Example

Weak

"I worked on optimizing a conductance-based neuron model using BluePyOpt, fitting parameters to whole-cell recordings from layer 2/3 interneurons across several iterations of the genetic algorithm."

Strong

"Computational models of real neurons are usually too slow or too crude to use in large networks. I built a faster, still-accurate version of one interneuron type, so labs modeling whole circuits can finally include it at scale."

No thesis project yet?

A · Bachelor Project

Pitch the part that was truly yours.

B · Course Assignment

A completed homework or lab report

C · Technology case study

Pitch a device you find interesting,
not your own work (e.g. see next slide)

D · Dream project

A problem you wish you were working on,
as a hypothesis

C · Technology case study

- **Cochlear** implant (sensory neuroprosthetics)
- Closed-loop neurostimulator for **seizure** control (neuroengineering, translational)
- Deep brain stimulation electrode (neurotechnology)
- Continuous glucose monitor (biosensors)
- Insulin pump / artificial pancreas (closed-loop control, medical devices)
- Wearable **ECG** patch for **arrhythmia** detection (biosignals, translational)
- **MRI**-guided focused ultrasound (imaging-guided therapy)
- Retinal implant / bionic eye (sensory neuroprosthetics)
- **Organ-on-a-chip** platform (microfluidics, translational research tool)
- Tissue-engineered scaffold for cartilage or skin repair (tissue engineering)
- 3D-printed prosthetic limb (biomechanics, applied)
- **CRISPR**-based point-of-care diagnostic (molecular bioengineering)

BWT, what do you do... when you don't know a certain word?

To DO now! (5 min, write it down!)

Your 30 second pitch

1. **Problem:** _____

2. **Approach:** _____

3. **Finding:** _____

4. **Relevance:** _____

5:00

Second attempt (after partner's feedback) _____

Work alone!

Work alone for 5 minutes

Deliver it to your partner!

30 second only

Write down the feedback

Thank for the feedback

Now with a partner (2 + 2 min)

4:00

Say it out loud

Tell each other **what** you wrote and **why**.
There is no need to agree!

This carries forward

Week 3: CV bullets.
Week 6: cold emails.

Now... let's "study" our Guest

How do they introduce their own work,
and which of the four parts they lead with.

Keep it. Next week, it becomes your professional **pitch**.
At the end of the term, it becomes your development plan.